

THE STARTER TO BUILDER FOUNDATION CHECKLIST

You don't need another idea. You need a foundation.

Check off what you have. Circle what you're missing. That's your starting line.

LEGAL & FINANCIAL

- ☐ Business entity is set up (LLC, etc.)
- ☐ EIN number secured
- ☐ Business bank account is separate
- ☐ Bookkeeping system in place
- ☐ Tracking income & expenses monthly
- ☐ Know my tax deadlines

MINDSET & GROWTH

- ☐ I know my vision in one sentence
- ☐ I've told people what I'm building
- ☐ I've cut out major distractions
- ☐ I celebrate small wins
- ☐ I learn from failures, not quit
- ☐ I show up even when unmotivated

OPERATIONS & SYSTEMS

- ☐ Daily routine is written down
- ☐ Tasks are tracked (not in my head)
- ☐ Client process is documented
- ☐ Deadlines have reminders set
- ☐ I review my week every Friday
- ☐ I have a simple filing system

BRAND & AUDIENCE

- ☐ I know who my audience is
- ☐ I post consistently (at least 3x/week)
- ☐ My profiles look professional
- ☐ I engage with my audience
- ☐ I have a product or offer ready
- ☐ I know my price point

YOUR SCORE

____ / 24 checked | The unchecked ones? That's your to-do list.

Lashanda Carter

Smart Tax IQ | Carter Cole & Associates LLC

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